

Disclaimer: I am not such an expert. This is just to give an idea.

Mapping Trajectories

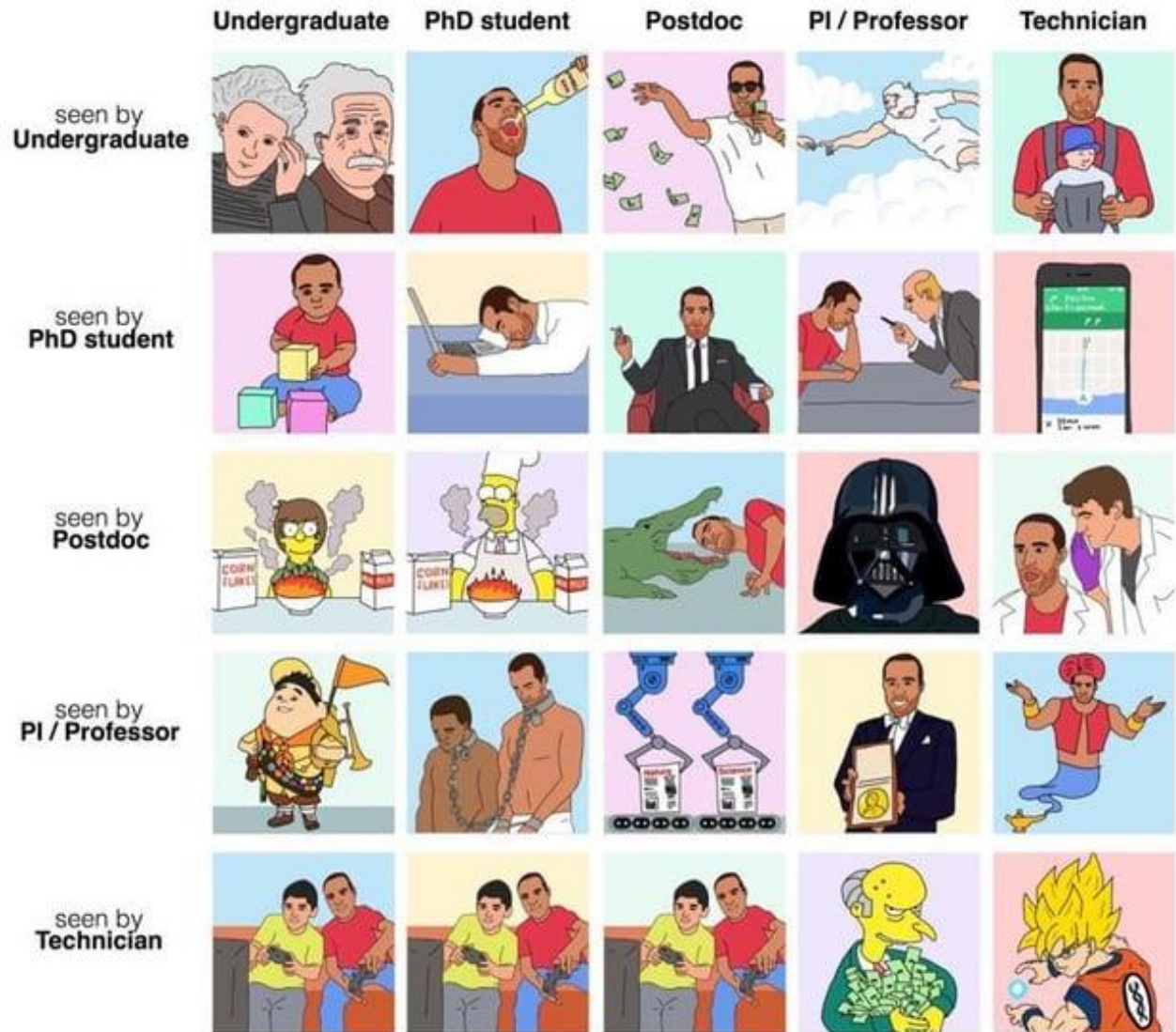
(Academia, Industry, and Beyond)

Presentation Preparation

Dr. Fatma Betul DINCASLAN

Who is This For?

People in Science



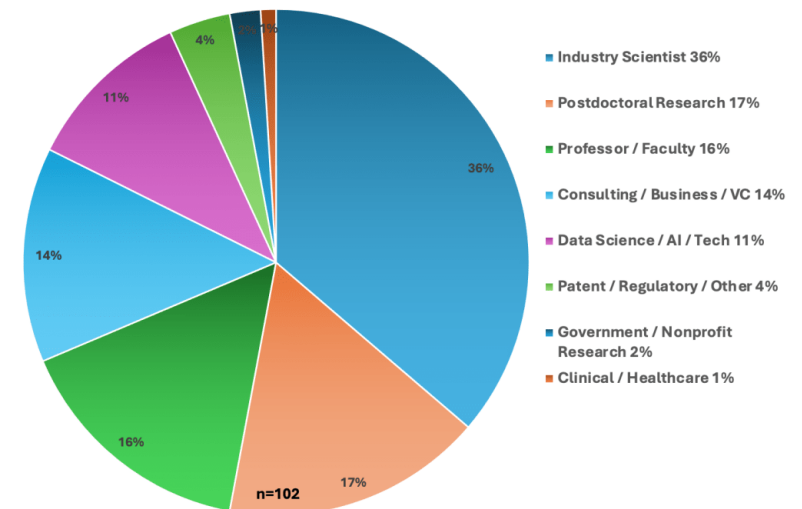
https://www.reddit.com/r/labrats/comments/nox84m/can_you_correlate_with_that/

Why To Think Start Early About Career Goals?



Nature Reviews | Molecular Cell Biology

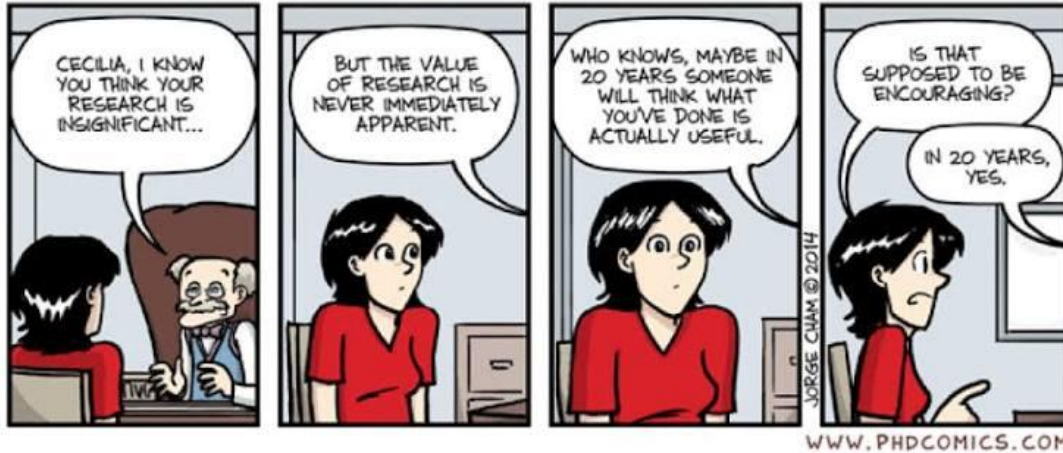
Position Types of CSB PhD Graduates (2009–2026)



<https://csbphd.mit.edu/csb-career-outcomes/>

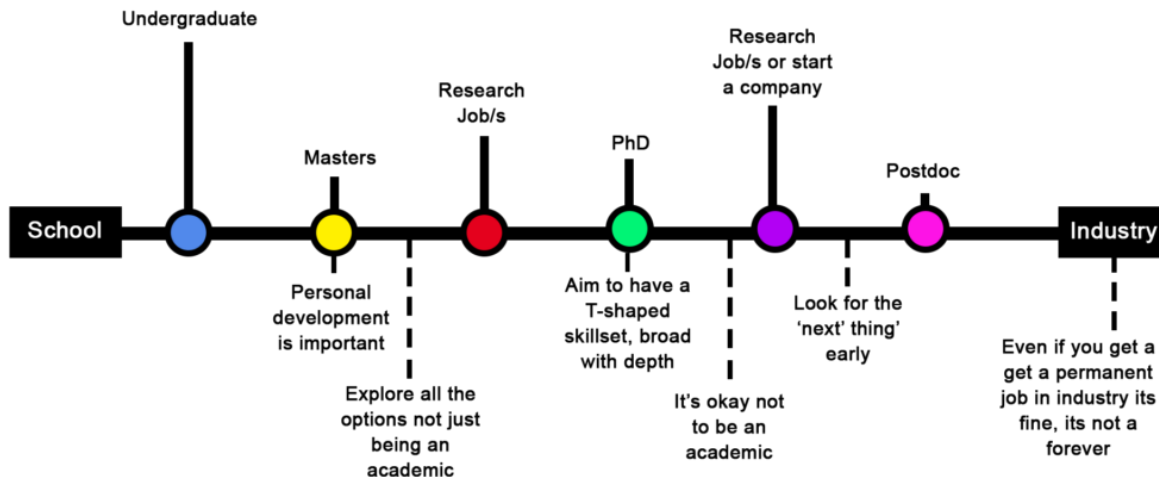
1. Academic positions are limited
2. PhD training is more than what you think
3. There are other ways of make impactful contribution to society
4. *Might have personal reasons such as salary expectations, better work-life balance, health reasons*

When Is the Right Time for the Transition?



Understand and focus on your personal journey before the decision:

- Self-development goals while being optimistic and realistic at the same time
- Enough time to explore the roles and diverse options before being stressed out
- Challenge your norms of success!



How to Be Prepared for Different Roles?

- **Skill transition**
 - Critical thinking
 - Scientific method
 - Technical writing
 - Data modelling
 - Independent and collaborative capacities
- **Embracing authenticity of career journey**
 - Personal choices leading the direction
 - Personal dominant abilities for the transition
 - People are your best resource: talk to them
- **Focus, plan and move**
 - Consider transition as new research project itself
 - Understand the role requirements before the application
 - Make a career timeline plan
 - Build experience (i.e., internships, volunteer roles, leaderships, commercial awareness)
 - Tailor CV/resume/cover letter and apply accordingly
 - Avoiding waiting too long or overthinking
- **Boundary spanning**
 - Skills having practical credibility across disciplines such as GitHub repositories
 - Compare and contrast opinions from both cultures and be aware of the norms



How to Be Prepared for Different Roles?

- **Preparing for interviews**

- Understand that there are set of interviews
- Take it seriously and read the invite carefully
- Google the company info and interviewer background
- Consider questions that can be asked (e.g., use AI tools where necessary to practice)
- Be ready for behavioral and competency questions
 - STAR Method
- Prepare your own question(s)
- Practice and remember the role requirement
- Reflect and follow-up afterwards



Situation (10%)
Task (15%)
Action (55%)
Result (20%)

In case of Uncertainties in Either Trajectory

No harm in keeping your foot in both if you are unsure during your journeys

Table 1 | Key tips for how to navigate a career in academia and industry if you wish to transition between the two

When in academia	When in industry
Read	Read
• Technical blog posts • Methods papers adjacent to your research area • Software and technical writing guides to improve your code and writing ability	• Research in your area of interest; subscribe to journal feeds • Feeds of publications and preprints on Google Scholar, Semantic Scholar and Scholar-Inbox
Assess your values	Assess your values
• Identify corporations, nonprofit organizations, startups and so on whose missions you find inspiring • Participate in internships • Evaluate what dimensions of academic work you enjoy: what are your ‘must haves’? • Stop by industry-led booths at conferences or workshops and send mentees to internships	• Are you growing as a professional? • Are you using the skills that you want to be using? • Do you have peers at work who value your knowledge and contributions? • Is your work affecting the world in the way you want it to? • Expand your knowledge of related careers and compare to your long-term skill and career goals
Share	Share
• Public-facing tools such as software • Analysis scripts and data • Perspective on theoretical and applied problems • Post on social media or make blog posts about your transferrable skills, such as LinkedIn, Notion or BlueSky • Present your studies at conferences • Workshop the practical weight of your work with colleagues and friends	• Write journal articles and conference proceedings papers for your academic research • Give presentations of relevant academic research for your team at work or reading groups • Stay in touch with colleagues and collaborators in academic research by email and at conferences

Helpful Resources

- **iBiology lecture series (w/examples):** <https://www.ibiology.org/professional-development/job-hunting-in-industry/>
- **EMBL resources (w/examples):** <https://www.embl.org/about/info/embl-fellows-career-service/blog/2019/01/writing-a-stand-out-job-application-for-industry/>
 - <https://zenodo.org/records/13944173/>
- **How to tailor CV/resumes for diverse roles (w/examples):** <https://career.ucsf.edu/gsp/cvs-resumes-cover-letters> (you can find out more in different universities websites)
- **Career timeline:** <https://prosper.liverpool.ac.uk/postdoc-resources/reflect/career-timelines/>

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